

18. Which one of the following is presided over by one who is not its member?

- (a) Lok Sabha (b) Vidhan Sabha
(c) Rajya Sabha (d) Council of Ministers

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

19. Among the four pairs given below which one consists of a correct-combination of dignitaries who became Vice-President after having held diplomatic posts of Ambassador and High Commissioners?

- (a) Dr. S. Radhakrishnan and G.S. Pathak
(b) Dr. S. Radhakrishnan and V.V. Giri
(c) Dr. Zakir Hussain and K. R. Narayanan
(d) B. D. Jatti and K. R. Narayanan

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Dr. S. Radhakrishnan was an Ambassador to the U.S.S.R from 1949 to 1952, and V.V. Giri was the High Commissioner to Sri Lanka from 1947 to 1951. K.R. Narayanan was also ambassador to China from 1976 to 1978.

20. Who among the following has held the office of the Vice-President of India?

1. Mohammad Hidayatullah
2. Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed
3. Neelam Sanjiva Reddy
4. Shankar Dayal Sharma

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, and 4 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Mohammad Hidayatullah was the sixth Vice-President of India from 1979 to 84, and Shankar Dayal Sharma was the Vice-President of India from 1987 to 92. Rest all were Presidents of India.

21. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) The Constitutional Amendment Bill has to be passed by both Houses of Parliament separately with special majority.
(b) Constitutional cases in Supreme Court is heard by minimum five Judges.

- (c) Freedom of Press is included in the fundamental right-Freedom of Speech and expression.
(d) Zakir Hussain was the first Vice-President of India.

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The given statement in the option (d) is incorrect because Dr. S Radhakrishnan was the first Vice-President of India who served in this post from 1952 to 1962. Dr. Zakir Hussain was the second Vice-President of India. He served in this post from 13 May, 1962 to 12 May, 1967.

22. The serial number of Mr. Mohammad Ansari as Vice-President of India is

- (a) 10th (b) 11th
(c) 12th (d) 13th

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Mohammad Hamid Ansari, the 12th Vice-President of India, entered the office in 2007. In July 2012, Mohammad Hamid Ansari was re-elected. The list of Vice-Presidents of India is given below.

1. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan	-	1952- 1962
2. Zakir Hussain	-	1962- 1967
3. V.V. Giri	-	1967- 1969
4. Gopal Swarup Pathak	-	1969- 1974
5. B.D. Jatti	-	1974- 1979
6. M. Hidayatullah	-	1979- 1984
7. R. Venkataraman	-	1984- 1987
8. Shankar Dayal Sharma	-	1987- 1992
9. K.R. Narayanan	-	1992- 1997
10. Krishna Kant	-	1997- 2002
11. Bhairon Singh Shekhawat	-	2002- 2007
12. Mohammad Hamid Ansari	-	2007- 2017
13. M. Venkaiah Naidu	-	2017- 2022
14. Jagdeep Dhankhar	-	2022- Incumbent

The Council of Ministers

*The Central Council of Ministers includes Cabinet ministers, Ministers of State and Deputy Ministers. *According to Article 74(1), there shall be a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to **aid and advise** the President, who shall, in the exercise of his functions, act in accordance with such advice. However, the President may require the Council of Ministers to reconsider such advice, and **the President shall act in accordance with the advice tendered after such reconsideration (added through the 44th Constitutional**

Amendment Act 1978). *The advice tendered by Ministers to the President shall not be inquired into in any court [Article 74 (2)]. *According to **Article 75 (1)**, the Prime Minister shall be appointed by the President and other Ministers shall be appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister. *According to Article 75 (1A), the total number of Ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the Council of Ministers shall not exceed **15%** of the total strength of the Lok Sabha. This provision was added by the **91st Amendment Act, 2003**. *As per Article 75(2), the Ministers shall hold office during the **pleasure of the President**. *The Council of Ministers shall be **collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha**. *The term ‘**Cabinet**’ was mentioned only in sub-section (3) of the **Article 352** of the Constitution and it was inserted by the **44th Constitutional Amendment Act**. It did not find a place in the original content of the Constitution. *It includes Cabinet Ministers and the Prime Minister. *Due to the **Ministerial Responsibility**, for every act of the bureaucrats, the concerned Minister is answerable to the Parliament. *The Central Cabinet secretariat is directly under the control of Prime Minister. Its administrative head is the **Cabinet secretary**, who is the **ex-officio chairman of the Civil Services Board**. *A person who is not a member of either house of the Parliament can also be appointed as a minister, but within **six months**, he must become a member (either by election or by nomination) of either house of the Parliament, otherwise he ceases to be a minister. *The President administers the oath of office and secrecy to the Prime Minister and other ministers. *The Prime Minister is the Chairman of Union Cabinet meetings. *According to **Article 78**, it shall be the duty of the Prime Minister to communicate to the President all decisions of the Council of Ministers and to furnish such information relating to the administration of the affairs of the Union and proposal for legislation as the President may call for. The Prime Minister submits his resignation to the President. The ministries of departments are created by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister under the Government of India (Allocation of Business Rules) 1961, which is a part of Article 77 of the Constitution. There are 52 ministries at present in the government of India. *The number of Ministries at the centre on 15 August 1947 was 18.

1. **As per Article 300 of the Constitution of India, the legal name of the Government of India is–**
 - (a) The Union Government
 - (b) The Union of India

- (c) India
- (d) Bharat

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (b)

As per Article 300 of the Constitution of India, the legal name of the government of India is 'The Union of India'.

2. **Consider the following statements and select the correct answer from the code given below:**

1. **The executive power of the Union is vested in the Prime Minister.**
2. **The Prime Minister is appointed by the President.**
3. **The Prime Minister is the head of the Council of Ministers.**
4. **The Prime Minister, at the time of his appointment, needs not be a member of either House of Parliament.**

Code :

- (a) Only 1, 2 and 4 are correct.
- (b) Only 1, 2 and 3 are correct.
- (c) Only 2, 3 and 4 are correct.
- (d) Only 1, 3 and 4 are correct.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (c)

According to Article 53(1) of the constitution, the executive power of the Union shall be vested in the President and shall be exercised by him either directly or through officers subordinate to him. The Prime Minister is appointed by the President and is the head of the Council of Ministers, and it is not necessary for a person to be a member of either House of the Parliament at the time of his appointment as the Prime Minister of India.

3. **Which of the following statements is correct about Prime Minister of India?**

- (a) Prime Minister is the nominal head of the Council of Ministers.
- (b) He is not responsible to the Parliament.
- (c) He cannot dismiss any of his ministers.
- (d) Prime Minister is the real head of the Council of Ministers.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (d)

According to **Article 74(1)**, "There shall be a council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President who shall, in the exercise of his function, act in accordance with such advice". Thus, the real power is vested in the Prime Minister.

4. Prime Minister of India is –

- (a) Elected
- (b) Selected
- (c) Nominated
- (d) Appointed
- (e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

The Prime Minister of India is appointed by the President, and other Ministers are also appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister [Art. 75 (1)].

5. The Prime Minister of India is the head of the –

- (a) State Government
- (b) Central Government
- (c) Both State and Central Governments
- (d) None of them

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

According to **Article 74(1)**, there shall be a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President. The Prime Minister of India is Head of the Government while the President of India is Head of the State.

6. Article 78 of the Constitution of India lays down the duties of the –

- (a) Speaker of Lok Sabha
- (b) Chairman of Rajya Sabha
- (c) Comptroller and Auditor General of India
- (d) Prime Minister

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (d)

Article 78 envisages the duties of the Prime Minister in respect of furnishing information to the President.

- (i) Relating to the administration of affairs of the Union
- (ii) If the President requires, submits for the consideration of the Council of Ministers any matter on which a decision has been taken by a minister but not considered by the Council.

7. Consider the following statements:

1. The Constitution of India classifies the ministers into four ranks viz. Cabinet Minister, Minister of State with Independent Charge, Minister of State and Deputy Minister.
2. The total number of ministers in the Union Government, including the Prime Minister, shall not exceed 15 percent of the total number of members in the Lok Sabha.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Article 74(1) says that there shall be a council of ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President. Thus, the Council of Ministers is a constitutional body. In the Indian constitution, there is no provision for the classification of ministers. It is based on British Parliamentary tradition. However, in the Indian parliamentary system at present time, instead of Prime Minister, there are the Cabinet Ministers, Ministers of State (Independent Charge), Minister of State and Deputy Ministers. As per Article 75(1A) inserted through the 91st Constitutional Amendment, 2003, total number of ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the council of ministers shall not exceed 15% of total strength of Lok Sabha. Similar amendments were also made under Article 164, inserted clause 1A, which says that total number of ministers, including the Chief Minister, in the council of ministers in a state shall not exceed 15% of the total number of members of the Legislative Assembly of that state.

8. Size of Council of Ministers has been restricted to 15 percent of membership of Lok Sabha by which Constitutional Amendment ?

- (a) 92nd Amendment
- (b) 95th Amendment
- (c) 91st Amendment
- (d) 93rd Amendment

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (c)

In the year 2003, the 91st Constitutional Amendment was passed. By amending Article 75 and Article 164 of the Constitution and making changes in the provisions regarding the Union and State Ministries, the total number of ministers, including the Prime Minister (in the union), and the Chief Ministers of the states, was limited to 15% of the total number of members in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies, respectively.

9. Cabinet means –

- (a) All Ministers in the Government
- (b) Ministers with Cabinet Rank
- (c) Cabinet Ministers and their Secretaries
- (d) Ministers of State

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

The Union Council of Ministers exercises executive authority. It contains a senior executive body called the Union Cabinet which is the supreme decision-making body in India. Only the Prime Minister and ministers of the rank of Cabinet Minister are members of the Cabinet.

10. Cabinet includes-

- (a) **Ministers with Cabinet-rank**
- (b) Minister of State level
- (c) Cabinet Minister and State Minister
- (d) Cabinet Minister, minister of state with independent charge and minister of state

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

11. The word 'mantrimandal' (cabinet) is mentioned only once in Constitution, and that is in-

- (a) Article 352
- (b) Article 74
- (c) Article 356
- (d) Article 76

41th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

The word "Cabinet" is mentioned in the Constitution of India in Article 352(3) which says, "The President shall not issue a Proclamation unless the Union Cabinet communicates to him in writing that such a Proclamation may be issued". It is noteworthy that the word 'Cabinet' has been mentioned two times in this Article.

12. With reference to the Union Government, consider the following statements :

- 1. **N. Gopalaswamy Ayyangar Committee suggested that a minister and a secretary be designated solely for pursuing the subject of administrative reform and promoting it.**
- 2. **In 1970, the Department of Personnel was constituted on the recommendation of the Administrative Reforms Commission, 1966, and this was placed under the Prime Minister's charge.**

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Sh. N. Gopalaswamy Ayyangar, in his Report namely 'Reorganization of the Machinery of Central Government' in 1950 recommended for the grouping of ministries, improvement in the capabilities of the personnel, and also in the working of the O&M Division.

It nowhere mentions that a minister and a secretary be designated solely for pursuing the subject of administrative reform and promoting it. Hence, statement 1 is not correct.

On 7th February 1973, the work relating to the Department of Administrative Reforms was transferred to the Department of Personnel created under Cabinet Secretariat on 1st August 1970, and was re-designated as the Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms.

In April 1977, the Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms was shifted from the Cabinet Secretariat to the Ministry of Home Affairs. In March 1985, the Department of Personnel and Administrative Reforms was elevated to a full-fledged Ministry of Personnel and Training, Administrative Reforms, Public Grievances and Pensions.

On December 10, 1985 Ministry of Personnel and Training, Administrative Reforms, Public Grievances and Pensions was re-designated as the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions with three departments namely, Department of Personnel and Training (DOPT), Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances and Department of Pension and Pensioners Welfare. **This Ministry was placed under the overall charge of the Prime Minister assisted by a Minister of State.** Hence, statement 2 is also not correct.

13. With reference to Union Government, consider the following statements:

- 1. **The Ministries/Departments of the Government of India are created by the Prime Minister on the advice of the Cabinet Secretary.**
- 2. **Each of the Ministries is assigned to a Minister by the President of India on the advice of the Prime Minister.**

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

The Ministries/Departments of the Government of India are not created by the Prime Minister on the recommendation of the Cabinet Secretary. The Cabinet Secretary is the head of the Cabinet Secretariat. He is also the chairman of the Civil Services Board. Each of the Ministries is assigned to a Minister by the President of India on the advice of the Prime Minister. Hence, statement (1) is incorrect, and statement (2) is correct.

14. Who exercises the actual/executive power under the parliamentary form of Government?

- (a) Parliament
- (b) Prime Minister
- (c) President
- (d) Bureaucracy

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

In the Parliamentary form of Government, the real executive power is exercised by the Prime Minister, and the provision regarding this is mentioned in **Article 75** of the Indian Constitution.

15. Consider the following statements:

- 1. **The President shall make rules for more convenient transaction of the business of the Government of India, and for the allocation among Ministers of the said business.**

2. All executive actions of the Government of India shall be expressed to be taken in the name of the Prime Minister.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

Article 77(1) says that all executive action of the Government of India shall be expressed to be taken in the name of the President. So, statement (2) is wrong whereas statement (1) is right. According to **Article 77(3)** the President shall make a rule for more convenient transaction of the business of Government of India and for allocation among Ministers of the said business.

16. If the Prime Minister of India belongs to the Upper House of Parliament:

- (a) He will not be able to vote in his favour in the event of a no-confidence motion
(b) He will not be able to speak on the budget in the Lower House
(c) He can make statements only in the Upper House
(d) He will have to become a member of the Lower House within six months after being sworn in as the Prime Minister

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

The Prime Minister or any Cabinet Minister has the right to speak and vote in the House where he is a member, but in the House where he is not a member, he can speak but does not have the right to vote. A Prime Minister, who belongs to the upper House of Parliament, cannot vote in his favour in the event of a no-confidence motion.

17. Which Article of the Indian Constitution describes the appointment and disqualification of the Council of Ministers.

- (a) Article 70 (b) Article 72
(c) Article 74 (d) Article 75

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

Article 75(1) states that the Prime Minister shall be appointed by the President and other Ministers shall be appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister. **Article 75(2)** states that the Ministers shall hold the office during the pleasure of the President.

18. Prime Minister of India is generally-

- (a) Not a member of Parliament
(b) Member of Lok Sabha

- (c) Member of Rajya Sabha
(d) Member of both the Houses

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The Prime Minister of India is generally a member of the Lok Sabha, but this is not compulsory or restricted. He can be a member of the Rajya Sabha. Indira Gandhi was the first PM from the Rajya Sabha at the time of appointment but later became a member of Lok Sabha.

19. The Prime Minister of India, at the time of his/her appointment

- (a) Need not necessarily be a member of one of the Houses of the Parliament but must become a member of one of the Houses within six months.
(b) Need not necessarily be a member of one of the Houses of the Parliament but must become a member of the Lok Sabha within six months.
(c) Must be a member of one of the Houses of the Parliament.
(d) Must be a member of the Lok Sabha.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

Article 75(5) says that a person who is not a member of either House can become a minister, but he cannot continue as minister for more than 6 months unless he secures a seat in either House of Parliament (by election or by nomination). These provisions also apply to the Prime Minister. So, option (a) is the correct answer.

20. What is the minimum age requirement to become the Prime Minister of India?

- (a) 21 years (b) 25 years
(c) 30 years (d) 35 years

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (b)

The minimum age requirement to become the Prime Minister of India is the same as that of a person to be a member of Lok Sabha, i.e. 25 years.

21. The Prime Minister is –

- (a) Elected by the Lok Sabha
(b) Elected by the Parliament
(c) Appointed by the President
(d) Nominated by the Party in Majority of Lok Sabha.

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Article 75(1) says that the Prime Minister shall be appointed by the President and other Ministers shall be appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister. **Article 75(2)** says that the Ministers shall hold the office during the pleasure of the President.

22. Which one of the following statements is correct about the Prime Minister of India?

- (a) He is free to choose his ministers only among those who are members of either House of the Parliament.
- (b) He can choose his cabinet colleagues after due counselling by the President of India in this regard.
- (c) He has full discretion in the choice of persons who are to serve as ministers in his cabinet.
- (d) He has only limited power in the choice of his cabinet colleagues because of the discretionary powers vested in the President of India.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The Prime Minister is the head of the Council of Ministers. He has full discretion in the choice of the person who is to serve as a Minister in his Cabinet [Article 75(1)]. He may choose any member apart from either house of Parliament, but such person will have to become a member of either House of Parliament within 6 months from the date he enters the office [Article 75(5)]. Otherwise, he will cease to be a Minister.

23. A Minister who for any period of six (6) consecutive months is not a member of either House of parliament shall cease to be a Minister after the expiry of this period. This is mentioned in which Article of the Constitution?

- (a) Article 75(5) (b) Article 75(3)
- (c) Article 75(4) (d) Article 75(2)

Chhattishgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. A Central Minister who is not the member of any House, can remain in the office for –

- (a) 1 year (b) 6 months
- (c) 3 months (d) 1 month

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

25. In India, a minister who is not a member of either House of Parliament will cease to be a minister after:

- (a) Six Months (b) One Year
- (c) Two Years (d) Three Years

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

26. Which of the following statements is not true regarding the Parliament of India.

- (a) The Constitution provides for a Parliamentary form of Government.
- (b) The function of the Parliament is to provide for a Cabinet.

- (c) The membership of the cabinet is restricted to the Lower House.
- (d) The cabinet enjoys the confidence of the majority in the popular chamber of the house.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

A person who is not a member of either House can also become a member of the Cabinet, but he cannot continue as minister for more than 6 months, unless he secures a seat in either House of the Parliament, i.e. Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha [According to Article 75(5)].

27. The Prime Minister of India is responsible to whom?

- (a) The Cabinet (b) The President
- (c) The Lok Sabha (d) The Rajya Sabha
- (e) More than one of the above

63rd B. P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

According to the Article 75 (3) of the Indian Constitution, the Council of Ministers (including the Prime Minister) shall be collectively responsible to the House of the People (Lok Sabha).

28. The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible:

1. To the House of the People
2. Under a Constitutional Obligation
3. As per Article 75 (3)
4. As per Article 74 (3)

Which of the above statements are correct?

- (a) 1, and 2 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

Ans. (b)

According to Article 75(3) of the Indian Constitution, the Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha. It is a constitutional obligation, Article 74(3) does not exist in the Constitution of India. Therefore, statements 1,2, and 3 are correct. Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

29. The Council of Ministers is responsible to the –

- (a) President (b) Prime Minister
- (c) Speaker (d) Parliament

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (*)

The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha. Since the Lok Sabha is not given in the option, so, nearest answer would be the Parliament.

30. To whom is the Council of Ministers responsible?

- (a) Parliament
- (b) President

- (c) Speaker of Lok Sabha
(d) Speaker of Lok Sabha and Chairman of Rajya Sabha

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

See the explanation of the above question.

31. The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to which of the following?

- (a) Prime Minister (b) President
(c) Rajya Sabha (d) Lok Sabha

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

32. Union Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to—

- (a) Prime Minister (b) President
(c) Parliament (d) Only to Lok Sabha

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

According to Article 75(3) of the Constitution, the Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the House of the People.

33. Consider the following statements in the context of Indian Constitution:

1. The Union Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha.
2. Union Ministers shall hold office during the pleasure of the Prime Minister.

Of these :

- (a) Only 1 is correct
(b) Both 1 and 2 are correct.
(c) Neither 1 nor 2 is correct.
(d) Only 2 is correct.

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

34. Assertion (A) : The Council of Ministers in the Union of India is collectively responsible both to the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.

Reason (R) : The members of both the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha are eligible to be the Ministers of the Union Government.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are individually true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
(b) Both (A) and (R) are individually true but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).

- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

U.P. B.E.O. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

The Council of Ministers in the Union of India is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha only [Article 75(3)]. So, Assertion (A) is false. The Union Minister can be a member of either House of the Parliament, but he is eligible to vote only in the House to which he belongs. Thus, Reason (R) is true.

35. Consider the following statements:

1. The Council of Ministers in the Centre shall be collectively responsible to the Parliament.
2. The Union Ministers shall hold the office during the pleasure of the President of India.
3. The Prime Minister shall communicate to the President about the proposals for Legislation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) All of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Statement 1 is incorrect. According to **Article 75(3)** of the Constitution, the Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha and not the Parliament. Statement 2 is correct as according to Article 75(2), ministers hold the office during the pleasure of the President. Statement 3 is also correct as Article 78(a) provides that it shall be the duty of the Prime Minister to communicate to the President all the decisions of the Council of Ministers related to the Administration of the affairs of the Union and proposals for legislation.

36. Which one of the following is not explicitly stated in the Constitution of India but followed as a convention?

- (a) The Finance Minister is to be a Member of the Lower House.
(b) The Prime Minister has to resign if he loses the majority in the Lower House.
(c) All the parts of India are to be represented in the Council of Ministers.
(d) In the event of both the President and the Vice-President demitting office simultaneously before the end of the tenure, the Speaker of the Lower House of the Parliament will officiate as the President.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

After losing the majority in the Lower House, the Prime Minister has to resign. This is not explicitly mentioned in the Constitution, but conventionally he resigns as he is the head of the Council of Ministers, which is collectively responsible to the House of the People according to Article 75(3).

37. In Indian Polity, the executive is subordinate to the-
- Judiciary
 - Legislature
 - Election Commission
 - Union Public Service Commission

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

In Indian Polity, the Executive is subordinate to the Legislature. Parliament is the supreme legislative body of the country. The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the House of the People.

38. Which one of the following motions, the Council of Ministers in India can move?

- No-Confidence Motion
- Censure Motion
- Adjournment Motion
- Confidence Motion

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

The Council of Ministers in India can move "Confidence Motion". A Motion of 'No Confidence' can be introduced only in Lok Sabha (the Lower House of the Parliament). The Government brings the 'Motion of Confidence' in Lok Sabha when it has to prove the confidence or support of a majority in the House of People (Lok Sabha).

39. The Council of Ministers has to resign if a no-confidence motion is passed by a majority of members of –

- Lok Sabha
- Rajya Sabha
- Both the Houses separately
- Both the Houses in Joint sitting

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

40. After resigning, whose permission does a minister require to give a statement in Lok Sabha?

- Prime Minister
- Speaker
- President
- Supreme Court
- None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

If a member resigns from the office of Minister, he can make a statement in the House about his resignation when allowed by the Speaker. It is, however, open to the member to make a statement or not, and he cannot be compelled to do so.

41. The number of Lok Sabha members required to table a 'No Confidence Motion' against the Council of Ministers is

- 30
- 40

(c) 50

(d) 60

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (c)

A minimum of 50 members are required to table a 'No Confidence Motion' against the Council of Ministers.

42. The least number of members who can table the No Confidence Motion against the Council of Ministers in Lok Sabha is –

- 20
- 30
- 40
- 50

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

43. Consider the following statements regarding a 'No-Confidence Motion' in India:

- There is no mention of a 'No-Confidence Motion' in the Constitution of India.
- A Motion of No-Confidence can be introduced in the Lok Sabha only.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

The 'No-Confidence motion' may be introduced only in Lok Sabha, and No-confidence motion is not mentioned in the Constitution. The procedure for 'No-Confidence Motion' is mentioned in the Rules of Procedure and conduct of Business of Lok Sabha (Rule No-198). Thus both the statements are correct.

44. Which one of the following statement is not correct regarding "No-Confidence Motion" ?

- 27 No-Confidence Motions, 9 Confidence Motions have been moved till 15th August, 2023.
- Lal Bahadur Shastri faced the most No-Confidence Motions per office year.
- The member who wants to move No-Confidence Motion give notice to the speaker of the Lok Sabha in writing.
- No-Confidence Motion can be moved only in Lok Sabha.
- Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (*)

Article 75(3) of the Indian Constitution embodies the rule, which specifies that the Council of Ministers are collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha. For testing this collective

responsibility, the rules of Lok Sabha provide a particular mechanism, a motion of no-confidence. The Constitution of India does not mention either a Confidence or a No Confidence Motion. A motion of "No Confidence against the Government can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha under Rule 198. According to Rule 198(1) (b), the member asking for such leave would need to give a written notice of the motion to the Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha. Any Lok Sabha MP, who can gather the support of 50 colleagues, can, at any point of time, introduce a motion of no-confidence against the Council of Ministers. It was during the third Lok Sabha in 1963 that the first motion of no-confidence was moved by Acharya J.B. Kripalani against the government headed by Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru. So far, 28 no-confidence motions (the 28th motion was brought on the ongoing situation in Manipur) and 11 confidence motions have been discussed (till 15th August 2023). The 50% of all confidence motions (14 out of 28) were discussed between 1965 and 1975. Of these, 12 were against governments headed by Indira Gandhi. [Note: The Commission (deleted the question)].

45. Which one of the following is not a correct situation arising after the resignation of the Council of Ministers?

- (a) President's Rule will be imposed.
- (b) The President will ask to continue till alternative arrangement.
- (c) The alternative arrangement means earliest possible General Election to be held to form a new Government.
- (d) Outgoing Council of Ministers may have had charge till the formation of the new Government

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

President Rule will not be imposed on the resignation of the Council of Ministers. Rest all options are correct.

46. Which leader of Madhya Pradesh became the Defence Minister first and later Home Minister in Nehru's Cabinet?

- (a) Prakash Chandra Sethi
- (b) Ravi Shankar Shukla
- (c) Kailash Nath Katju
- (d) Dwarka Nath Mishra

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Kailash Nath Katju was included in Nehru's Cabinet in the year 1951 as Law Minister, and in the same year, he became the third Home Minister of the country. Later, in 1955, he held the office of Defence Minister. He also served as Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh from 1957 to 1962.

47. Who was the First Finance Minister of Independent India?

- (a) Gulzari Lal Nanda
- (b) John Mathai
- (c) Krishnamachari
- (d) Sarojini Naidu

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (*)

R.K. Shanmukham Chetty served as the first Finance Minister of independent India (1947-1948) in Jawaharlal Nehru's Cabinet.

48. Who was the Law Minister in the first Cabinet of post-independence India?

- (a) K.M. Munshi
- (b) S.P. Mukherjee
- (c) Baldev Singh
- (d) B.R. Ambedkar

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar was the first Law Minister of post-independence India, while Jogendra Nath Mandal was the Law Minister in the interim government formed in 1946.

49. Among the following given names, whose portfolio in the first cabinet of India (1947) was different from his portfolio in the Interim Government (1946)?

- (i) Jagjivan Ram
- (ii) Dr. Rajendra Prasad
- (iii) C.H. Bhabha
- (iv) Sardar Baldev Singh
- (a) Only (i) and (ii)
- (b) Only (iii) and (iv)
- (c) Only (i) and (iii)
- (d) Only (iii)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Portfolios in the Interim Cabinet are as follows:
Food and Agriculture - Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Labour- Jagjivan Ram, Defence - Sardar Baldev Singh, Works Mines and Power - C.H. Bhabha.

Portfolios in the first cabinet of Independent India are as follows : Food and Agriculture - Dr. Rajendra Prasad, Defence Sardar Baldev Singh, Labour - Jagjivan Ram, Commerce - C.H. Bhabha.

Thus, the Portfolio of C.H. Bhabha in the first Cabinet of Independent India was different from his Portfolio in the Interim Government. So the correct answer is the option (d).

50. Who was the 12th Prime Minister of India?

- (a) Chandra Shekhar (b) Deve Gowda
(c) I.K. Gujral (d) A.B. Vajpayee

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Deve Gowda was the 12th Prime Minister of India (including the term of acting Prime Minister Gulzari Lal Nanda). Narendra Modi is the 15th Prime Minister of India.

51. Match the Prime Ministers with their tenure.

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------|
| A. Deve Gowda | i. 1999-2004 |
| B. Chandra Shekhar | ii. 1989-90 |
| C. Atal Bihari Vajpayee | iii. 1990-91 |
| D. Inder Kumar Gujral | iv. 1996-97 |
| E. Vishwanath Pratap Singh | v. 1997-98 |

Code :

- | | | | | |
|-----------|-------|-------|------|------|
| A | B | C | D | E |
| (a) (i) | (ii) | (iii) | (iv) | (v) |
| (b) (v) | (iv) | (iii) | (ii) | (i) |
| (c) (iii) | (i) | (ii) | (v) | (iv) |
| (d) (iv) | (iii) | (i) | (v) | (ii) |
| (e) (ii) | (i) | (iii) | (v) | (iv) |

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Vishwanath Pratap Singh	–	1989-90
Chandra Shekhar	–	1990-91
H.D. Deve Gowda	–	1996-97
I.K. Gujral	–	1997-98
Atal Bihari Vajpayee	–	1999-2004

Significantly, the tenure of Atal Bihari Vajpayee as Prime Minister is as follows;
He took charge as Prime Minister of India on May 16, 1996 to June 1, 1996, and from March 19, 1998 to April 26, 1999 and from October 13, 1999 to May 22, 2004.

52. Who among the following held the office of the Prime Minister of India more than once?

1. Jawaharlal Nehru
2. Indira Gandhi
3. Gulzari Lal Nanda
4. Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Choose the correct code:

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 1,2 and 4 (d) All of above

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

All the persons mentioned above have held the office of the Prime Minister of India more than once, and Gulzari Lal Nanda was the Acting Prime Minister twice.

53. Who among the following occupied the office of the Prime Minister of India more than once with gaps in between their political career ?

1. Jawaharlal Nehru
2. Lal Bahadur Shastri
3. Gulzari Lal Nanda
4. Indira Gandhi
5. Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Code :

- (a) 1,2 and 3 only (b) 1,3 and 4 only
(c) 3, 4 and 5 only (d) 1,2,4 and 5 only

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

Except for Jawaharlal Nehru and Lal Bahadur Shastri, the other three have held the office of the Prime Minister of India more than once with gaps in between their tenure.
Gulzarilal Nanda (27 May 1964 - 9 June 1964, 11 Jan 1966-24 January 1966)
Indira Gandhi (24 May 1966 - 24 March 1977, 14 Jan 1980-31 Oct 1984)
Atal Bihari Vajpayee (16 May 1996- 1 June 1996), 19 March 1998-22 May 2004).

54. Which Prime Minister died outside India?

- (a) Jawahar Lal Nehru
(b) Morarji Desai
(c) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(d) Charan Singh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

The second Prime Minister of India, Lal Bahadur Shastri died, outside India, in Tashkent (the Capital city of Uzbekistan) on 11 January, 1966.

55. Match the following States and their respective Chief Ministers, who became Prime Minister of India.

List -I

List-II

- | | |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A. P.V. Narasimha Rao | i. Undivided Uttar Pradesh |
| B. Morarji Desai | ii. Undivided Andhra Pradesh |
| C. H.D. Devegowda | iii. Gujarat |
| D. Charan Singh | iv. Karnataka |
| E. Narendra Modi | v. Bombay |

Codes:

A	B	C	D	E
(a) iv	v	ii	i	iii
(b) iv	ii	v	i	iii
(c) ii	i	iv	v	iii
(d) ii	v	iv	i	iii

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020**Ans. (d)**

Chief Ministers who became Prime Ministers:	
Prime Ministers	States
P. V. Narasimha Rao	Undivided Andhra Pradesh
Morarji Desai	Bombay
H.D. Devegowda	Karnataka
Charan Singh	Undivided Uttar Pradesh
Narendra Modi	Gujarat

56. Who amongst the following had never been the Chief Minister of any State before becoming the Prime Minister of India?

- (a) H.D. Dev Gowda (b) P.V. Narasimha Rao
(c) Chandra Shekhar (d) Morarji Desai

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011**Ans. (c)**

Chandra Shekhar had never been the Chief Minister of any State before becoming the Prime Minister of India.

57. Which of the following person was not a Chief Minister of any state before holding the office of Prime Minister?

- (a) Morarji Desai (b) P.V. Narasimha Rao
(c) Charan Singh (d) Chandra Shekhar

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994**Ans. (d)**

Except for Chandra Shekhar, all the three had served as Chief Minister of a State, before holding the office of Prime Minister.

58. Who among the following was the member of Lok Sabha during his Prime Ministership?

- (a) Deve Gowda (b) I.K. Gujral
(c) Chandrashekhar (d) Dr. Manmohan Singh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015**Ans. (c)**

Deve Gowda, I.K. Gujral, and Dr. Manmohan Singh were not the members of the Lok Sabha during their Prime Ministership, while Chandra Shekhar was the Prime Minister of India from 1990 to 1991 and also the Member of Parliament from Balia Lok Sabha Constituency.

59. Which one of the following Prime Ministers of India, never attended the Parliament during his tenure?

- (a) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(b) V.P. Singh
(c) Chandra Shekhar
(d) Chaudhari Charan Singh

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001**Ans. (d)**

Chaudhari Charan Singh was the Prime Minister of India from 28 July, 1979 to 14 January, 1980. During his tenure, he never attended the Lok Sabha as the Indian National Congress withdrew its support before the sitting of Lok Sabha.

60. Who among the following have been the Union Finance Ministers of India?

- V. P. Singh
- R. Venkataraman
- Y. B. Chavan
- Pranab Mukherjee

Select the correct answer by using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1, 3 and 4
(c) 2 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007**Ans. (d)**

All the persons mentioned in the above options have been the Union Finance Ministers of India.

V.P. Singh	(1984-87)
R. Venkataraman	(1980-82)
Y.B. Chavan	(1971-75)
Pranab Mukherjee	(2009-2012)

61. The Policy of Liberalisation, Privatisation, and Globalisation was announced as New Economic Policy by Prime Minister

- (a) Rajeev Gandhi
(b) Vishwanath Pratap Singh
(c) P.V. Narasimha Rao
(d) Atal Bihari Vajpayee

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013**Ans. (c)**

The policy of liberalisation, privatisation, and globalisation was announced as New Economic Policy by Prime Minister Narasimha Rao on 24 July, 1991.

62. Which of the following statements is not true for Dr. Manmohan Singh?

- (a) Former Finance Minister of India
- (b) Former Governor of Reserve Bank of India
- (c) Former Chairman of Finance Commission
- (d) Former Representative of India at the IMF

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Dr. Manmohan Singh has served in all the above posts except as a Chairman of the Finance Commission.

63. Prime Minister Manmohan Singh is a –

- (a) Member of Lok Sabha from Punjab
- (b) Member of Rajya Sabha from Punjab
- (c) Member of Rajya Sabha from Rajasthan
- (d) Member of Rajya Sabha from Assam

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (d)

Dr. Manmohan Singh served as Prime Minister from 2004 to 2014. He was first elected as a member of Rajya Sabha from Assam in 1991. Later, he again became a member of Rajya Sabha from Assam in the years 1996, 2001, 2007 and 2013. In 2019, he again got elected as a Rajya Sabha member representing Rajasthan.

64. Assertion(A) : Ministers make policy and civil servants adhere to that policy.

Reason(R) : Parliamentary form of government works on the Principle of "Cabinet Collective Responsibility"

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (A) is correct explanation of (R).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is not correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A) as the Parliamentary form of government works on the principle of "Cabinet's Collective Responsibility" and policies made by the Cabinet are adhered to by civil servants.

65. Consider the following statements and choose the correct answer from the code given below

Assertion (A) : Describing a person as Deputy Prime Minister is a political decision.

Reason (R) : It does not confer on him any power of the Prime Minister.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but, (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but, (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

In the Constitution of India, the duty and office of the Deputy Prime Minister are not mentioned, but conventionally, a Cabinet Minister can be declared as a Deputy Prime Minister. It does not confer on him any power of the Prime Minister. So, both statements (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).

66. The Office of the Deputy Prime Minister –

- (a) Was created under the original Constitution.
- (b) Is an extra-Constitutional growth.
- (c) Was created by 44th Amendment.
- (d) Was created by the 85th Amendment.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

The Office of the Deputy Prime Minister is not mentioned anywhere in the Constitution of India. The post was created due to political necessity and is purely a non-Constitutional post.

67. Who was the first Deputy Prime Minister of India?

- (a) Sri Morarji Desai
- (b) Sri Jagjivan Ram
- (c) Chaudhary Charan Singh
- (d) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Chhattishgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

India's first Deputy Prime Minister was Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, who served from 15 August 1947 to 15 December 1950. Along with being the Minister of Home Affairs, he played a significant role in the unification of India by integrating over 500 princely states into the Indian Union, ensuring the country's territorial and political consolidation.

68. Consider the following statements:

1. The Executive Power of the Union of India is vested in the Prime Minister.
2. The Prime Minister is the ex-officio Chairman of the Civil Services Board.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (d)

The executive power of the Union of India is not vested in the Prime Minister but in the President (Art. 53(1)). The Constitutional head of the executive of the Union is the President. Article 74(1) of the Constitution provides that there shall be a Council of Ministers with the Prime Minister as its head to aid and advise the President, who shall, in the exercise of his/her functions, act in accordance with such advice. The Cabinet Secretariat is under the direct charge of the Prime Minister. The administrative head of the Secretariat is the Cabinet Secretary, who is also the ex-officio Chairman of the Civil Services Board. Thus, neither 1st nor 2nd statement is correct.

69. With reference to Union Government, consider the following statements:

1. The Constitution of India provides that all Cabinet Ministers shall be compulsorily the sitting members of Lok Sabha only.
2. The Union Cabinet Secretariat operates under the direction of the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (d)

The Council of Ministers seldom meets as a body. It is the Cabinet, an inner body within the Council, that shapes the policies of the Government. Cabinet Ministers hold the charge of key portfolios. There is no bar on the appointment of a person from outside the legislature as a minister, but he cannot continue for more than six months unless he secures a seat in either House of the Parliament in the meantime. A minister, who is a member of one House has the right to speak and to take part in the proceedings of the other House, though he has no right to vote in the house of which he is not a member. The Union Cabinet Secretariat is not operated under the direction of the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs. Union Cabinet Secretariat is under the supervision of the Prime Minister's Office. Its administrative Chief is the Cabinet Secretary, who is the Ex-officio Chairman of the Civil Services Board. The cabinet secretary is the highest civil services officer of the central government. Hence both the statements are false.

70. Read the following statements related to Cabinet Committees and choose the correct option:

Statement I : Cabinet Committees are not mentioned in the constitution.

Statement II : Cabinet Committees are set up by the Prime Minister according to the exigencies of the time and requirements of the situation.

Statement III : If Prime Minister is the member of Committee, he may not necessarily be the Chairman of Committee.

Statement IV : Parliamentary Affairs Committee is chaired by the Prime Minister.

- (a) All statements are true
(b) Statements I, II and III are true, but Statement IV is false.
(c) Statements II, III and IV are true but Statement I is false.
(d) Statements I and II are true, but Statement III and IV are false.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Cabinet Committees are not mentioned in the Constitution. So, they are extra - constitutional bodies. Rules of Business provide for their establishment. Thus, Statement I is true. Cabinet Committees are set up by the Prime minister according to the exigencies of the time and requirements of the situation. Thus, Statement II is true. Cabinet Committees are mostly Chaired by the Prime Minister. Sometimes, other Cabinet Ministers, the Finance Minister or the Home Minister also acts as chairman but in case if the Prime Minister is the member of the Committee, he is necessarily the Chairman of the Committee. Thus, Statement III is false. Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs is chaired by the Minister of Defence, not by the Prime Minister. Thus, Statement IV is false.

71. Which one of the following Constitutional Amendments states that the total number of Ministers, including the Prime Minister in the Council of Ministers, shall not exceed fifteen percent of the total number of members of the House of the People?

- (a) 90th (b) 91st
(c) 92nd (d) 93rd

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003 says that the total number of Ministers, including Prime Minister in the Council of Ministers, shall not exceed fifteen per-cent of the total number of members of the Lok Sabha. This provision was added in **Article 75(1A)** through the 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003.

72. Which of the following Constitutional Amendment Acts restricted the size of the Council of Ministers to 15 percent of the total members of the Lok Sabha ?

- (a) 95th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2009
(b) 93rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 2005
(c) 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003
(d) 90th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

73. With reference to Union Government, consider the following statements:

1. The number of Ministries at the Centre on 15th August, 1947 was 18.
2. The number of Ministries at the Centre at present is 36.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

The number of Ministries at the Centre on 15th August, 1947 was 18. At present the number of ministries at the centre is 53.

74. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs in India was established in the year.

- (a) 1991 (b) 1995
(c) 1999 (d) 2001

Chhattishgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The Ministry of Tribal Affairs was set up in 1999 after the bifurcation of Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment with the objective of providing a more focused approach towards the integrated socio-economic development of the Scheduled Tribes (the most underprivileged section of the Indian Society) in a coordinated and planned manner. Before the formation of the Ministry, tribal affairs were handled by different Ministries at different points in time. The Ministry of Tribal Affairs is the Nodal Ministry for overall policy planning and coordination of programmes for development of STs.

75. An Indian appointed as the Chairman of the International anti-war Organization in 1988, was –

- (a) Morarji Desai (b) Rajiv Gandhi
(c) Narayan Desai (d) Bhulabhai Desai

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

War Resisters International is an international anti-war association of more than 40 countries. It was founded in 1921 in Bilthoven, Netherlands. It is headquartered in London, U.K. Narayan Desai was the chairman of this organization from 1988 to 1991.

76. Match List-I with List- II and select the correct answer using the code given below.

List-I (Person)	List-II (Designation)
A. Nagender Singh	1. Chief Election Commissioner of India
B. A.N. Roy	2. President International Court of Justice
C. R.K. Trivedi	3. Chief Justice of India
D. Ashok Desai	4. Attorney-General of India

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	4	2	3
(b)	2	3	1	4
(c)	1	3	2	4
(d)	2	4	1	3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

Nagendra Singh served as the President of the International Court of Justice from 1985 to 1988. A. N. Roy was appointed as the Chief Justice of India on April 26, 1973. R.K. Trivedi worked as Chief Election Commissioner of India from 18 June, 1982 to 31 December, 1985. Ashok Desai was the Attorney-General of India.

77. Who among the following was appointed as the first Director General of the Unique Identification Authority of India created in June, 2009?

- (a) Mr. Montek Singh Ahluwalia
(b) Mr. Nandan Nilekani
(c) Mr. Ashok Desai
(d) Mr. Ram Sewak Sharma

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2013

Ans. (d)

Nandan Nilekani was the first chairman of the Unique Identification Authority of India, whereas, R.S. Sharma was its first Director General. UIDAI was created in June, 2009. Since 12 July, 2016, the post of chairman became chief executive officer (CEO). Presently, Bhuvnesh Kumar is CEO of UIDAI.

78. Sarosh Zaiwalla is famous as a –

- (a) Renowned Dramatist
(b) Renowned wildlife Photographer
(c) Renowned International Law Expert
(d) Renowned Handicap Surgeon

I.A.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

The former member of the International Court of Arbitration of the ICC Paris (1990-2002), Sarosh Zaiwalla is a renowned law expert. He was given India's Annual National Law Day Award by the Indian Prime Minister for his outstanding contribution in the field of International Arbitration Law.

79. After elections to the 18th Lok Sabha, who was appointed as the Union Minister of Textiles in the Modi government ?

- (a) Giriraj Singh (Begusarai)
(b) Bhupendra Yadav (Alwar)
(c) Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh (Munger)
(d) Gajendra Singh Shekhawat (Jodhpur)

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (a)

After the 18th Lok Sabha elections, Giriraj Singh was appointed as the Union Minister of Textiles in the Modi government. It is worth noting that Giriraj Singh is a Member of Parliament (MP) from Begusarai (Bihar) in the 18th Lok Sabha.

80. Recently who has been assigned the charge of the Ministry of Minority Affairs?

- (a) Smriti Irani (b) Amit Shah
(c) Nirmala Sitharaman (d) Piyush Goyal
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2021

Ans. (a)

The Minister for Minority Affairs was Smriti Zubin Irani, while the minister of state minority was John Barla (during the question period). The Ministry of Minority Affairs was carved out of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment and created on 29th January, 2006 to ensure a more focused approach towards issues relating to the notified minority communities namely Muslim, Christian, Buddhist, Sikhs, Parsis and Jain. The Minister for Minority Affairs at present (2025) is Kiren Rijiju.

81. Which of the following official documents is related with India?

- (a) Green Paper (b) White Paper
(c) Yellow Book (d) Blue Book

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

A White Paper is an official document issued by the Government of India or by its Ministry which explains the Government policies on a particular subject and allows the Government to collect feedback before a bill is prepared.

82. The Reorganization of Union Cabinet is based on the Report of-

- (a) Gopalaswami Ayyangar (b) K.M. Munshi
(c) T.T. Krishnamachari (d) B.C. Roy

U.P.P.C.S. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

The Reorganization of the Union Cabinet is based on the Report of N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar.

83. Consider the following statements about the Cabinet Secretariat.

1. The Cabinet Secretariat functions directly under the Vice-President of India.
2. The administrative head of the Secretariat is the Cabinet Secretary who is also the ex-officio Chairman of the Civil Services Board.

Which of the statements/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 Only (b) 2 Only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

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Ans. (b)

The Cabinet Secretariat functions directly under the Prime Minister. Significantly, the administrative head of the secretariat is the cabinet secretary who is also the ex-officio chairman of the civil services board.

84. Who is the highest Civil Services Officers of the Central Government ?

- (a) The Attorney General of India
(b) The Cabinet Secretary
(c) The Home Secretary
(d) The Finance Secretary
(e) None of the above / more than one of the above

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Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

85. Which of the following is/are the function/functions of the Cabinet Secretariat?

1. Preparation of agenda for Cabinet Meetings
2. Secretariat assistance to Cabinet Committees
3. Allocation of financial resources to the Ministries

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

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Ans. (c)

The 'Cabinet Secretariat' has been given a place in the 1st Schedule of the rules made under the Government of India (Allocation of Business) Rules, 1961.

The Subjects allotted to the Secretariat are:

- (i) Secretariat assistance to the Cabinet and the Cabinet Committees
- (ii) The administration of the Rules of Business
The Secretariat assistance provided by the Cabinet Secretariat to the Cabinet and Cabinet Committees are:
 1. Convening of the meeting of the Cabinet on the orders of the Prime Minister.
 2. Preparation and circulation of the agenda.
 3. Circulating papers related to cases on the agenda.
 4. Preparing a record of discussions taken
 5. Circulation of the record after obtaining the approval of the Prime Minister.
 6. Watching implementation of the decisions taken by the Cabinet.
- (iii) Promotion of Inter-Ministerial Coordination. The coordination is required for removing difficulties, removing differences, overcoming delays, coordination in administrative actions and coordination of policies.